PAWPOLLER · GETTING STARTED GUIDE

Instagram

Track views/reach/likes/comments/saves and post photos to Instagram.

Analytics + Posting | Involved Setup

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WHAT YOU'LL NEED

- A Business or Creator Instagram account
- A free Meta developer app — the same one Threads uses, if you have that too
- A long-lived access token
- About 20 minutes, on a computer

STEP BY STEP 0 / 21 DONE

1. **Open Microsoft Edge or Firefox, not Chrome**
   Do every step on a computer, in any browser that is **not Chrome**. Chrome breaks Meta's token generator: the button does nothing and no error appears. ☐

2. **In the Instagram phone app, open Account type and tools**
   Your profile → ☰ **menu** → **Settings and activity** → **Account type and tools**. Menu names vary a little between versions. ☐

3. **Tap Switch to professional account**
   Pick **Business** or **Creator**; either works. Skip connecting a Facebook Page. Personal accounts can't use the API at all. Already professional? Tick this off and go on. ☐

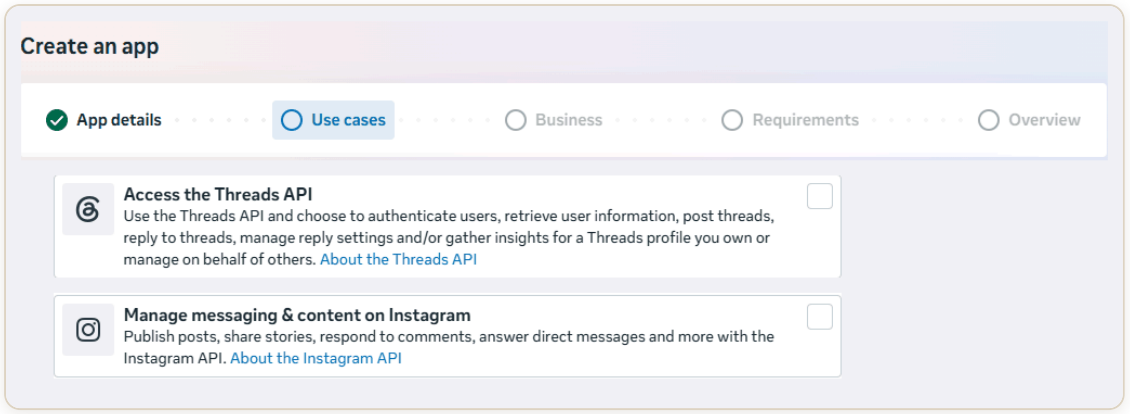
4. **Open Meta's My Apps page and sign in**
   Sign in with your Facebook account. If Meta asks you to register as a developer first, do that (stuck on a text-message code? see **Good to know**). You'll see **My Apps**. developers.facebook.com/apps ↗ ☐

5. **Press Create app**
   Already have an app for PawPoller? Open it, press **Add use cases**, do step 7, then carry on from step 9. ☐

6. **Type any app name and press Next**
   Up to 30 characters, for example *My PawPoller*. The contact email is filled in for you. ☐

7 Tick Manage messaging & content on Instagram, then Next

The **Content management** filter on the left shortens the list. Want Threads too? Tick *Access the Threads API* as well; one app serves both.



Create an app: the Use cases step, with Access the Threads API and Manage messaging & content on Instagram

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8 Skip the business portfolio and finish the wizard

Choose **I don't want to connect a business portfolio yet**, press **Next** through Requirements, then **Create app**. You'll land on the app's dashboard.

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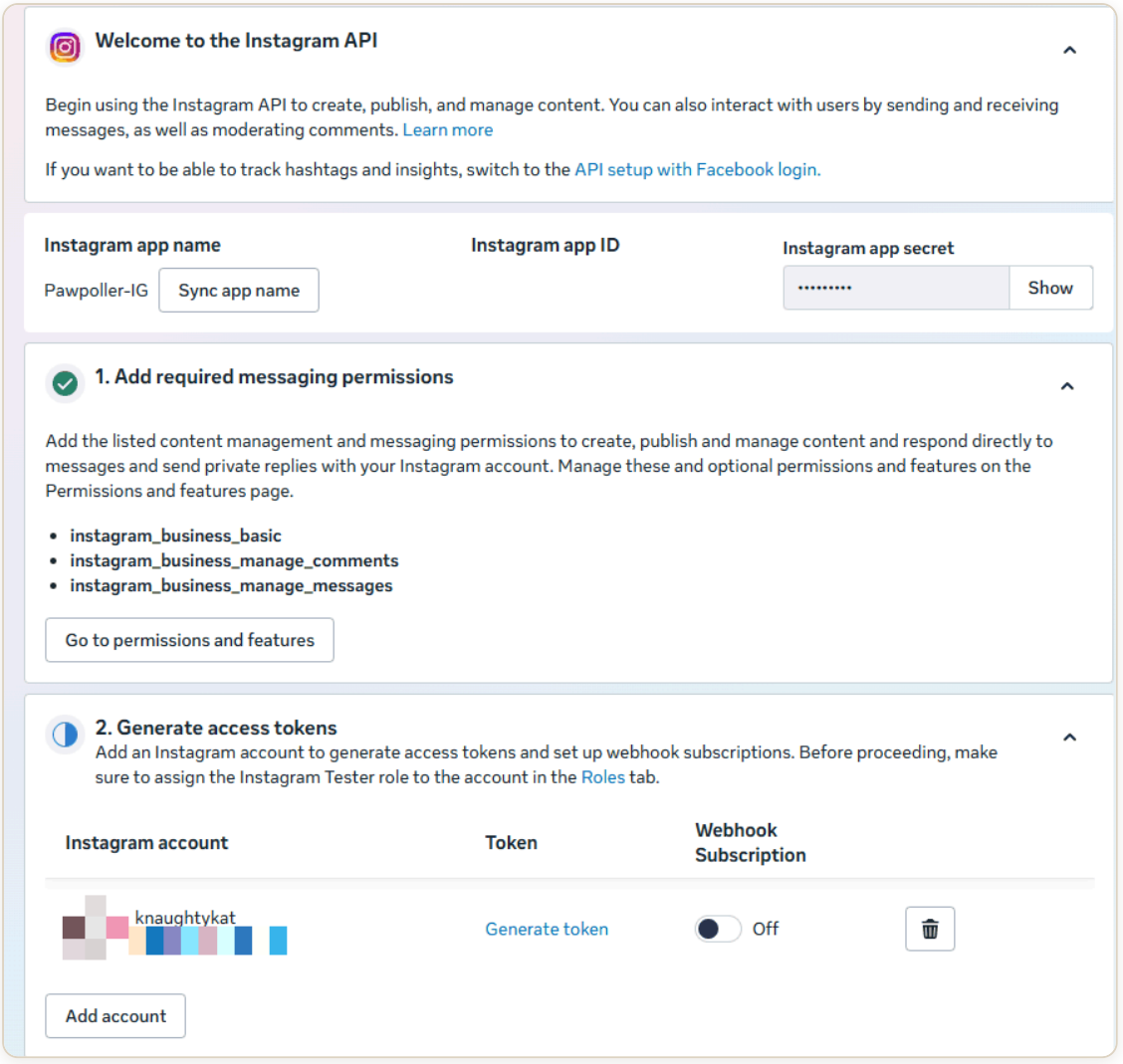
9 Open Use cases → Customize next to the Instagram use case

Left sidebar **Use cases**, then **Customize** beside *Manage messaging & content on Instagram*. Meta opens the **API setup with Unified login** tab first.

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10 Click the API setup with Instagram login tab

Not *Unified login* (PawPoller can't use its token yet), not *Facebook login* (needs a Facebook Page). A banner calls this tab "legacy": it still works, ignore it. You'll see your Instagram app name and **2. Generate access tokens**. **No such tab?** Meta no longer offers it to new apps (its guide of October 2026); see *Unified login* under Good to know.



API setup with Instagram login: app name and id, section 1 messaging permissions, section 2 Generate access tokens with one tester account and a Generate token link

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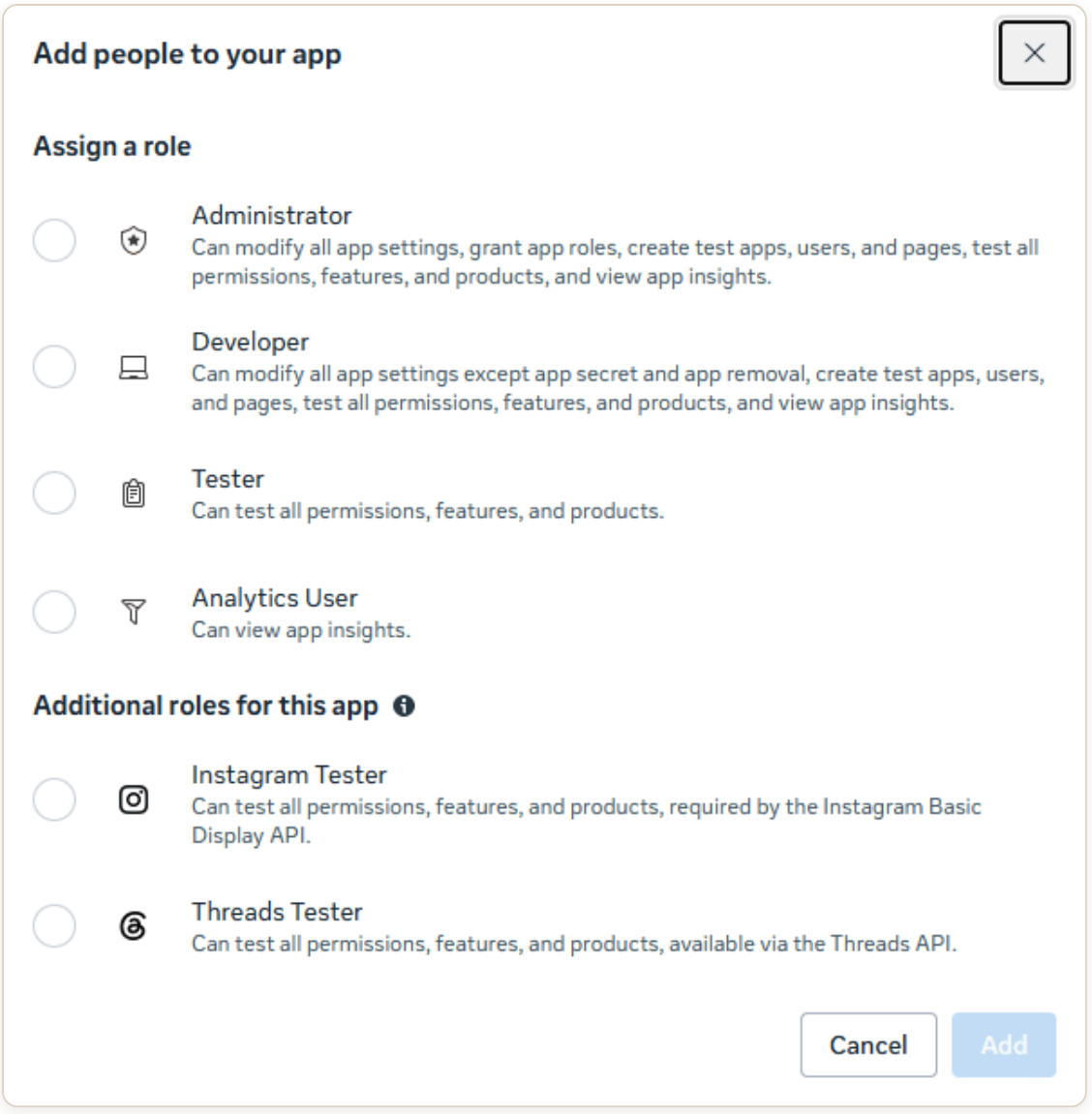
11 Left sidebar: App roles → Roles, then Add People

A box called *Add people to your app* opens.

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12 **Pick Instagram Tester, type your Instagram username, press Add**

It's under *Additional roles*. Your username now shows as **Pending**.



Add people to your app: Instagram Tester and Threads Tester under Additional roles

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13 **Accept the invite in Instagram**

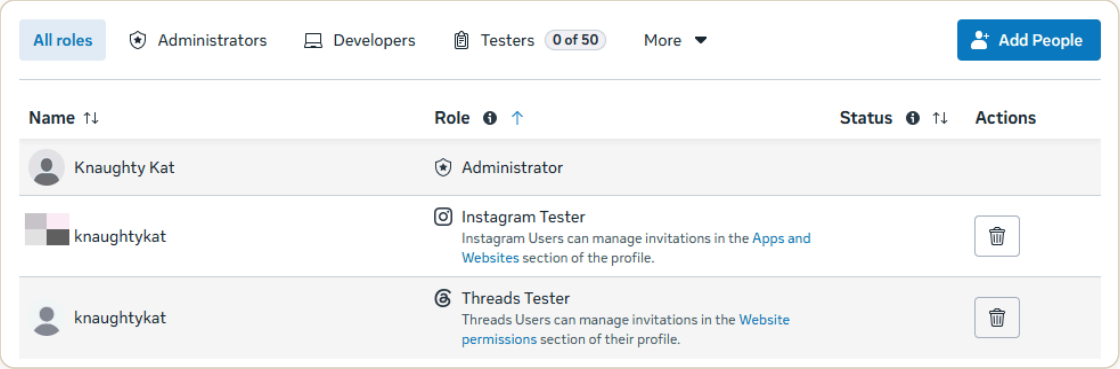
In a new tab, signed in as **that same** Instagram account: **Settings** → **Website permissions** → **Apps and websites** → **Tester invites** → **Accept**. Instagram doesn't notify you about it.

instagram.com/accounts/manage_access ↗

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14 Reload the Roles page in Meta

Pending is gone and you're listed as an Instagram Tester. Still pending? The invite was accepted on a different Instagram account.



App roles: one Administrator, one Instagram Tester and one Threads Tester, with the Add People button

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15 Go back to API setup with Instagram login, section 2

Use cases → Customize → API setup with Instagram login, then open **2. Generate access tokens**.

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16 Press Add account and sign in to Instagram

Skip this if your account is already listed. Afterwards your account appears in the table with a **Generate token** link.

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17 Press Generate token on your account's row

A window opens. If nothing happens, allow pop-ups for developers.facebook.com, or you are in Chrome (step 1).

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18 Approve everything it asks for

It asks for the basic, insights, publishing, comments and messages permissions in one go. Turn none of them off: without publishing, stats work but every post is rejected.

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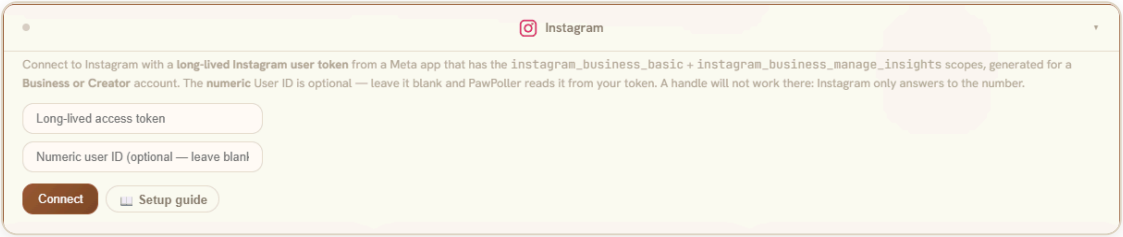
19 Copy the whole token

It's several hundred characters. Meta may only show it once, so keep it somewhere safe until it's in PawPoller.

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20 In PawPoller: Settings → Platforms → Instagram, paste it into Access token

Leave **User ID** blank; PawPoller works it out from the token.



PawPoller Settings, Instagram card: access token, optional user id, Connect

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21 Press Connect

The dot turns green and shows a username. Check it's the account you meant.

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WHERE IT GOES IN PAWPOLLER

Settings → Instagram → Access token (user id optional — leave blank)

KEEPING IT ALIVE

Long-lived tokens last ~60 days. PawPoller auto-refreshes it while polling. If it lapses, generate a fresh token in section 2 of *API setup with Instagram login* and paste it back in — the app, tester role and use case all stay valid.

GOOD TO KNOW

- You can skip Meta's sections **1** (messaging permissions), **3** (webhooks), **4** (business login) and **5** (App Review). The **Permissions and features** table is for App Review too: the token generator asks for all five scopes whatever it says.
- Every Instagram post **requires a photo** — there are no text-only posts. Instagram fetches the image from a public address, and PawPoller finds it one: your own server if you have one, otherwise the PawPoller relay (a public PawPoller server hosts the picture for 15 minutes), otherwise a temporary tunnel from your PC. Nothing to set up; see **Settings** → **Posting** → **Instagram image host** to switch either off or to download the tunnel helper.
- Leave the app **Unpublished**. Development mode with your own account needs no App Review, and the Publish button stays greyed out until you add a privacy policy — you do not need one. A public app for other users would need review and would likely be rejected for adult content.
- Stuck registering as a Meta developer (no text-message code, or a loop)? Stop requesting codes, then confirm your phone number in ordinary Facebook settings, where the code comes by email. The full list of fixes is in `docs/INSTAGRAM_SETUP.md` §1b.
- ▶ **Unified login — coming soon**